Appendix A. Details of design, procedures and instructions

A1. Instructions of observer and competition tasks (*addition/effort* variant)

Today, we are going to play a few games with you. In all the games, you will earn points that will be converted into money and placed in your virtual wallet. At the end of the experiment you will receive a card with the money you earned and you will be able to purchase items from the cafeteria. You will get many points today, so hopefully you will be able to purchase many items.

TROPHY GAME

There are two tasks in this game: the "Slider Task" and the "Observer Task." The "Slider Task" is a competition. You will be matched in pairs with another student in the room, but you will not know who this person is (see Figure 8 for the corresponding slides).

[SLIDE 1]

You will see sliders with the cursor in a certain position between 0 and 100, in this example it is at 32. Your job will be to move the cursor exactly to the position 50. Whoever puts more cursors in 50 wins. Let's try one on your screen. This is not for real. It's just for you to know how it works.

[Start SLIDER TRAINING]

Put the cursor at 50. Once you have done it, press NEXT. When the time comes to play the Slider Task, you will see many sliders on your screen. It will look like this.

[SLIDE 2]

You will have 90 seconds to put as many cursors as possible at 50. You will have to work fast to beat the other person.

[SLIDE 3]

At the end of the 90 seconds, if you put more cursors at 50 in your screen than the other student puts in his, you will win the trophy game and receive 3 tokens. if you put fewer cursors than the other student, you will lose and get only 1 token. Each token is worth $1, so you will earn either $1 or $3. Is this task clear?

The other task you are going to play is the "Observer Task". In this task, we give you 4 extra tokens that you have to allocate between a winner and a loser of the slider task.

[SLIDE 4]

This is you [point to the screen]. We give you 4 free tokens.

[SLIDE 5]

All you have to do is split the 4 tokens between the winner and the loser. There is only one rule. You have to give at least one token to each. So, do you want to give 3 tokens to the winner who already has 3 tokens and give 1 to the loser who already has 1 token? Or do you want to give 2 and 2? Or do you want to give 1 to the winner and 3 to the loser? Remember each token is worth $1. Your screen will look like this.

[SLIDE 6]

You allocate tokens by clicking on the dashed tokens. If you change your mind, you can move tokens from one player to another. Once you are happy, press OK. Remember that you will play both the Slider Task and the Observer Task. However, it is very important to understand that you will play with different persons. Let's look at this example.

[SLIDE 7]

You play the Observer Task and allocate tokens to two students who play the Slider Task against each other. You also play the Slider Task but with different people. So, you will earn 1 or 3 tokens with the Slider Task and also receive 1, 2 or 3 tokens from an Observer. Since each token is worth \$1, you will get between \$2 and \$6 dollars just with this game.

OK. The computer will now select the groups.

We will start by playing the "Observer Task" and ask you to tell us how you would like to allocate your tokens between two students in this room who will play the "Slider Task" in just a moment. How many to the winner and how many to the loser.

[Start THIRD PARTY DICTATOR]

Please choose the allocation and press OK.

[Wait for participants to finish]

We will now play the "Slider Task". In a moment, you will see all the sliders. When you are ready press START and try to put as many cursors as possible at 50. At the end, you will see how many cursors you managed to put at 50.

[Start SLIDER TASK]

You will now see a reminder telling you what you chose in the Observer Task. Think about it. If you are happy with the choice you made, click OK. If you have changed your mind, click CHANGE and re-do the allocation. Then press OK.

[Start THIRD PARTY REALLOCATION]

On your screen, you will now see a questionnaire. Please answer the questions. We will tell you at the end of the session, whether you won the Slider Task and how many tokens you got in total.

[Start QUESTIONNAIRE 1 about difficulty and performance]

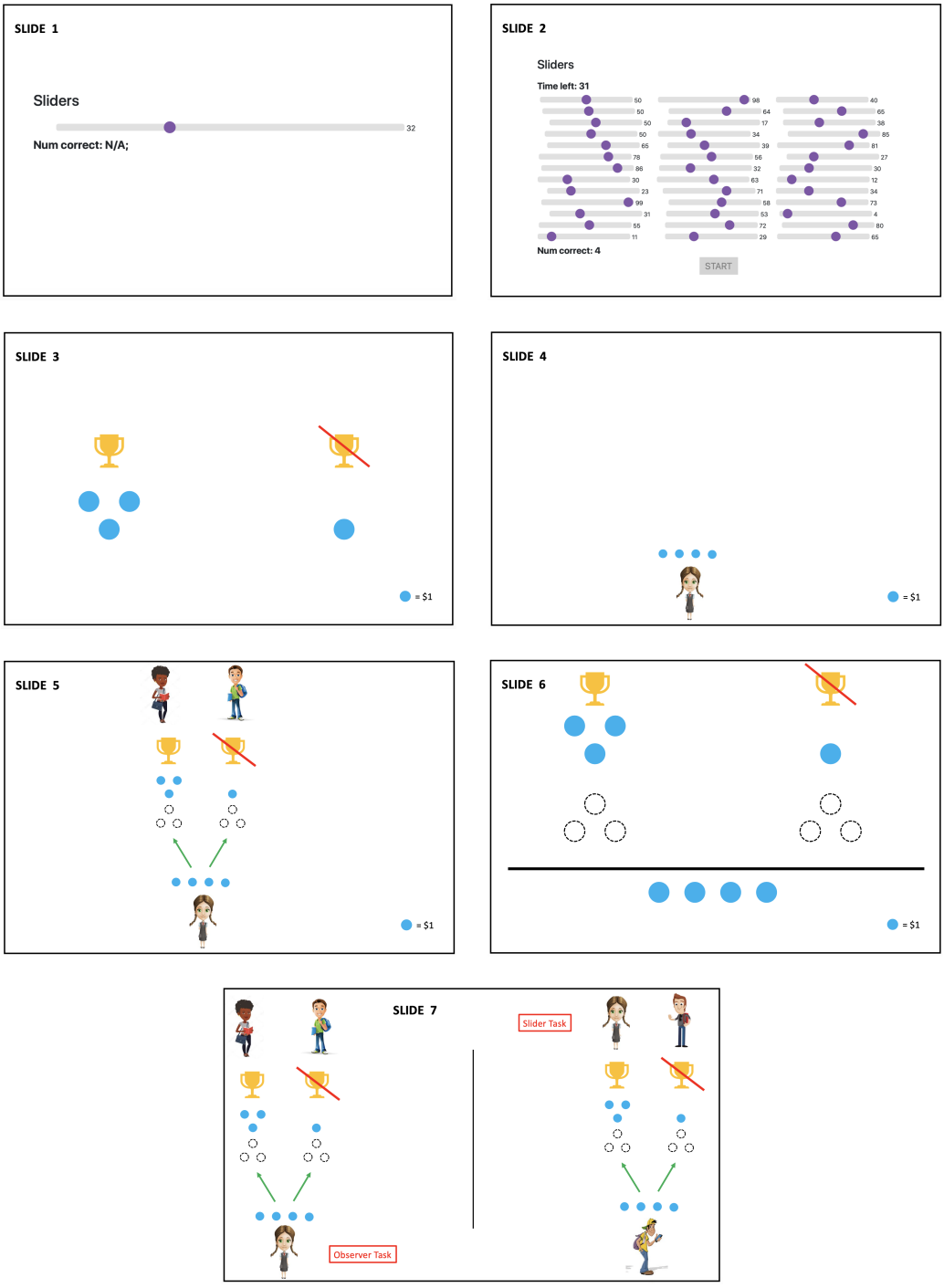


Figure 8: Slides projected on screen for instructions